txt2latex(1)

User Commands

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NAME

txt2latex - convert flat ASCII text to LaTeX .

SYNOPSIS

`txt2latex` `[`*`OPTION...`*`]` *`FILE`*

DESCRIPTION

txt2latex converts the input text into LaTeX .

If input file *FILE* is omitted, standard input is used. Result is displayed on standard output.

txt2latex is also able to recognize sections, paragraphs, lists (itemize, enumerate, description), verbatim blocks as well as inline maths and equations.

The rules for processing the text patterns are defined as following:

Sections They are defined by a line in upper case starting at column 1. Preceding blank lines are allowed for better visualization.

Paragraphs They must be left aligned and preceded by a blank line. Blank spaces at the beginning of the paragraphs are allowed and there is no restriction on line alignement in a paragraph. Nonetheless, identical alignment provides a better visualization of the plain ASCII text.

Description list Labels of the items are separated from the definitions by at least 2 blank spaces, even before a new line, if definition is too long.

Itemize (bullet) list Bullet list items are defined by the first character being ”-”, ”*” or ”o” followed by a space.

Enumerated list Enumerated lists are defined by the first character being a number followed by a dot or a rounded bracket.

Nested lists Nested and mixed lists are allowed.

Verbatim block Verbatim block is used to display unmodified text such as quotes of source code. They must be separated by a blank line and be indented with respect to the previuous line. It will be printed using the verbatim environment.

Mathematics Inline mathematics must be enclosed with a simple $ sign and equations must be enclosed with double $ signs. For example, $E = mc^2$ is rendered as an inline math whereas

$$E = mc^2$$

is rendered in a simple equation environment.

Tables There is no support for tables. The workaround is put them in a verbatim block.

Special characters #, $, %, &, _, {, }, ^ \ are protected i.e. escaped.

Symbols such as $<$, $>$, $<$=, $>$= are transformed to inline math.

Special words such as LaTeX and TeX are turned into their equivalent commands in latex for generating special output.

OPTIONS

-d date Set date. Defaults to current date.

-t mytitle Set the title. If the title is set, txt2latex will automatically add the preambule and markups for the document

-a author Set the author.

-s shift Shift heading level by 0 (section), 1 (subsection), or 2 (subsection). Defaults to 0.

-m, –man Apply the conventions for man pages. See NOTES.

-I txt Italicize txt in output. Can be specified more than once.

-B txt Emphasize (bold) txt in output. Can be specified more than once.

-P package Add packages or LaTeX or TeX commands in the preambule.

-X Compile output with pdflatex.

-v, –version Display version.

-h, –help Display help.

NOTES

The formatting rules are heavily inspired from txt2man(1). The special treatment for sections NAME and SYNOPSIS performed automatically by txt2man(1) is not done by **txt2latex**. Nonetheless, the objective of **txt2latex** is not to parse on man-formatted plain text but to convert any plain text to LaTeX .

Using the options -B and -I, you can easily format your text as it would be done by txt2man.

EXAMPLES

Simple conversion

```
$ txt2latex FILE > FILE.tex
```

Conversion with document title

```
$ txt2latex -t "title" -a "author" -I "word" FILE > FILE.tex
```

Conversion with custom packages and direct rendering with pdflatex

```
$ txt2latex -t "title" -a "author" -I "word" -P "\\usepackage{ccfonts}" -X FILE
```

Try this command to format this text itself and to produce a pdf:

```
$ txt2latex -h 2>&1 | txt2latex -t "txt2latex(1)" -a "User commands" --man -X
```

Compare it to the man page generated by txt2man(1):

```
$ txt2latex -h 2>&1 | txt2man -s 1 -t txt2latex -v "User commands" -r 0.3.0 | man -l -Tpd
```

SEE ALSO

txt2man(1)